



The Most Dangerous School Runs in the World **Comprehension Questions**

1. Why do you think the author begins the text with a rhetorical question?

2. What words or phrases can you find in the article that suggest danger or difficulty?

3. What makes Syria so dangerous for students?

4. Why might the author have used the subheading 'Dangers of a Different Kind'?

5. How might children in Chile and Myanmar get to school?

6. Explain what you think a 'non-legally binding instrument' is, based on the text of the article.

7. Who has documented the journey across the Zaskar River in the Himalayas?

8. List three challenges for children journeying to school in the Pamir mountain region.

Extension

- Research one of the dangerous school runs mentioned in the article. What more can you find out?



The Most Dangerous School Runs in the World **Comprehension - Answers**

1. Why do you think the author begins the text with a rhetorical question?
The author attempts to make the reader consider their own reasonably simple route to school. This will encourage interest and empathy with the children in the article.
2. What words or phrases can you find in the article that suggest danger or difficulty?
There are a number including 'no easy feat' and 'arduous'.
3. What makes Syria so dangerous for students?
Syria has been in a civil war since 2011. There are reports of over 4,200 attacks on schools and many children are killed while travelling to school.
4. Why might the author have used the subheading 'Dangers of a Different Kind'?
The subheading connects the previous natural difficulties with those in this section (man-made dangers including war and crime).
5. How might children in Chile and Myanmar get to school?
Children might reach school by mule (Chile) or bull (Myanmar).
6. Explain what you think a 'non-legally binding instrument' is, based on the text of the article.
Answers may vary but some understanding that it means it 'encourages' rather enforces governments. The author writes that it has huge 'political and moral gravitas'.
7. Who has documented the journey across the Zaskar River in the Himalayas?
BBC's *Human Planet* programme.
8. List three challenges for children journeying to school in the Pamir mountain region.
Challenges include: walking 50 miles on foot or camel; scaling 1,000 foot cliffs; trekking on a narrow path cut into a cliff face; wading through four freezing rivers and zip lining 600 feet through the air.

Extension

- Research one of the dangerous school runs mentioned in the article. What more can you find out?
Students might watch one of the highly interesting and informative videos on YouTube. A search for *Dangerous School Runs* shows many interesting results including quick summary programmes and more in-depth material.